

Animal groups

Scientists have sorted, or **classified**, all animals into two categories. Animals with a backbone are called **vertebrates** and those without one are called **invertebrates**. These two main types can be divided into smaller animal groups.

Vertebrates

Animals with backbones come in many different shapes and sizes. Some animals live on dry land, while others live on or in water.

Reptiles

This animal group has scaly skin. Reptiles lay eggs and are cold-blooded, which means they use sunlight to warm up their bodies. Snakes are reptiles.



Birds

All birds have two wings, two feet, a beak, and feathers. However, not all birds can fly. Eagles are birds of prey.



Mammals

These animals are warm-blooded, which means they create heat inside their bodies. Mammals have hair or fur. This wolf is a type of mammal.

Most mammals do not lay eggs. Instead, they give birth to live young and feed them milk.



Amphibians

These vertebrates live near water so their bodies do not dry out. Amphibians lay their eggs in water. Frogs are amphibians.



Fish

Fish have gills for breathing underwater. They have slippery scales, fins, and a tail. Most fish lay eggs, but some give birth to live young. This yellow perch is a type of fish.